

PERSONAL WEAPONS

While the rifle was the prime weapon of the infantryman, other troops, such as officers, NCOs, tank crews, and airmen, required something more manoeuvrable for their personal protection. The solution to their requirement was provided by submachine-guns, pistols, and revolvers – all of which used the light but low-powered pistol round. In practice, revolvers and pistols were rarely used in combat, but the submachine-gun, which was light and had a high rate of automatic fire, proved to be a key weapon of World War II. It was particularly useful in close-combat conditions, such as house-clearing and jungle fighting.

► THOMPSON M1921

Date	1921
Origin	US
Weight	4.88kg (10¾lb)
Barrel	26.7cm (10½in)
Calibre	.45 ACP

Nicknamed the “Tommy Gun”, the Thompson submachine-gun was an effective weapon but expensive to manufacture and somewhat difficult to maintain.



Forward pistol grip

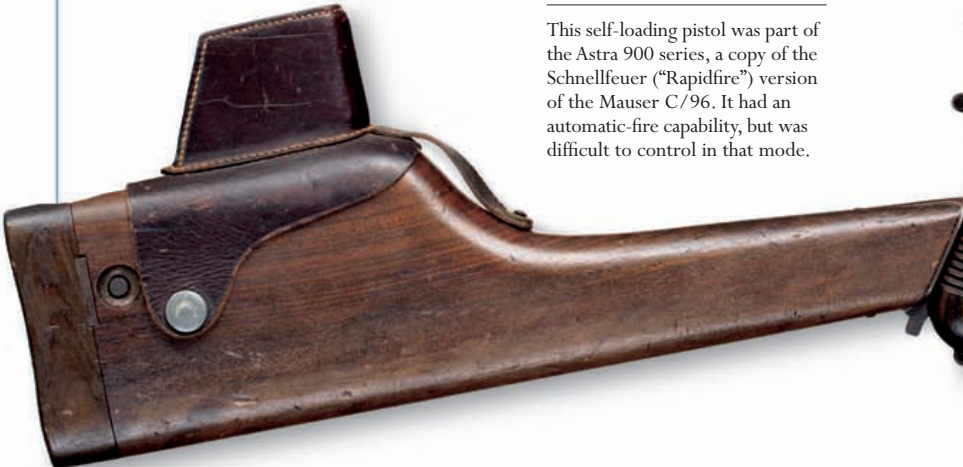
Eight-round magazine

Winder for clockwork mechanism

▲ TOKAREVTI MODEL 1933

Date	1933
Origin	Soviet Union
Weight	830g (29½oz)
Barrel	11.6cm (4½in)
Calibre	7.62mm

The Tokarev TT33 was the first self-loading pistol to be issued to the Red Army. It lacked a safety catch, but could be put on half-cock.



▼ ASTRA M901

Date	1927
Origin	Spain
Weight	2.1kg (4¾lb)
Barrel	16cm (6½in)
Calibre	7.63mm Mauser

This self-loading pistol was part of the Astra 900 series, a copy of the Schnellfeuer (“Rapidfire”) version of the Mauser C/96. It had an automatic-fire capability, but was difficult to control in that mode.

► COLT M1911A1

Date	1924
Origin	US
Weight	1.1kg (2½lb)
Barrel	12.7cm (5in)
Calibre	.45in ACP

Adopted in response to demands for a handgun with guaranteed stopping power, the Browning-designed M1911A1 replaced the M1911 of World War I. It was used by the US armed forces during World War II and after.



Recoil spring housing

Butt houses seven-round removable magazine

Receiver machined from solid steel billet

Magazine release catch

Rear pistol grip

50-ROUND DRUM MAGAZINE

► BROWNING GP35

Date	1935
Origin	Belgium
Weight	990g (35oz)
Barrel	11.8cm (4¾in)
Calibre	9mm Parabellum

A Browning-designed pistol, the GP35 was used by both Allies and Germans during World War II. It proved to be both rugged and reliable and continues in use today.



20-round fixed magazine